

Questions 1 to 4 are based on the conversation you have just heard.

- A) Renting a car instead of driving their own.
- B) Surfing online to check out the best deals.
- A) He once owned a van.
- B) He was well travelled.
- A) Ensure the safety of passengers.
- B) Drive under any weather condition.
- A) Having one's basic needs covered while away from home.
- B) Enjoying the freedom to choose where to go and work.
- C) Slowing down in one's increasingly hectic life.
- D) Riding one's mountain bike on vacation.
- C) Exploring more summer holiday resorts.
- D) Spending their holidays in a novel way.
- C) He did not find holiday homes appealing.
- D) He did not like to be locked into one place.
- C) Receive instructions via computers.
- D) Generate their own electricity.

Questions 5 to 8 are based on the conversation you have just heard.

- A) She has missed several important appointments lately.
- B) Her job performance has worsened over the past month.
- C) She has lagged behind most of her co-workers in output.
- D) Her physical health has deteriorated these past few weeks.
- A) Serious health issues.
- B) Disturbance of her mind.
- A) The woman's work proficiency.
- B) The woman's whole-hearted support.
- A) The woman will resume her work in two weeks.
- B) The man will be back at his 100% in a couple of weeks.
- C) The woman will be off work on the next two Mondays.
- D) The man will help the woman get back to her usual self.
- C) Some problems at home.
- D) Penalty for curtailed output.
- C) His engaging personality.
- D) His management capability.

Directions: In this section, you will hear two passages. At the end of each passage, you will hear three or four questions. Both the passage and the questions will be spoken only once. After you hear a question, you must choose the best answer from the four choices marked A), B), C) and D). Then mark the corresponding letter on **Answer Sheet 1** with a single line through the centre.

Questions 9 to 11 are based on the passage you have just heard.

- A) It can have an impact on our moods and emotions.
- B) It can enable us to live a healthier and longer life.
- C) It can improve our financial status significantly.
- D) It can help us achieve better work performance.
- A) One's health tends to differ before and after marriage.
- B) One's health status is related to one's social background.
- C) The wealthier one's spouse is, the healthier one becomes.
- D) The spouse's level of education can impact one's health.
- A) They benefited a lot from their career achievements.
- B) They showed interest in their spouse's occupations.
- C) They had much in common with their spouses.
- D) They had more education than their spouses.

Questions 12 to 15 are based on the passage you have just heard.

- A) Eliminating their root cause.
- B) Forecasting flood risks accurately.
- A) To validate his hypothesis about the gravity of floods.
- B) To determine the frequency of high tides causing floods.
- C) To improve his mathematical flooding model.
- D) To see the feasibility of his project on flooding.
- A) To study the consequences of high tides on flooded areas.
- B) To teach local citizens how to collect data of incoming floods.
- C) To forecast rapid floods in real time.
- D) To classify the flooding data processed.
- A) They set up Internet-connected water-level sensors.
- B) They tracked the rising tides with video-cameras.
- C) They used newly-developed supercomputing facilities.
- D) They observed the direction of water flow on the spot.

Section C

Directions: In this section, you will hear three recordings of lectures or talks followed by three or four questions. The recordings will be played only once. After you hear a question, you must choose the best answer from the four choices marked A), B), C) and D). Then mark the corresponding letter on **Answer Sheet 1** with a single line through the centre.

Questions 16 to 18 are based on the recording you have just heard.

- A) To argue about the value of a college degree.
- B) To debate the validity of current survey data.

- D) To compare men without college degrees with those who have.
- A) The increase in women taking up jobs.
- C) The factor of wages.
- B) The issue of changing job requirements.
- D) The impact of inflation.
- A) Men's unwillingness to accept low wages in times of growing inflation.
- B) The wage gap between those with college degrees and those without.
- C) More jobs requiring their holders to have a college degree nowadays.
- D) The sharp decline in marriage among men with no college degrees.

Questions 19 to 21 are based on the recording you have just heard.

- A) More and more people attach importance to protecting endangered animals.
- B) More and more people prioritize animal welfare when buying things to wear.
- C) An increasing number of people demand to free animals being kept in cages.
- D) An increasing number of people follow the latest trend of becoming vegetarians.
- A) Avoided the use of leather and fur.
- C) Refrained from using chemicals in their products
- B) Labelled all their products as vegan.
- D) Utilized a silk substitute made from mushrooms.